AFSPA

BOOTS STRAPPED

From April 1, the Armed Forces Special Powers Act (AFSPA), 1958, was removed from several districts across Assam, Nagaland and Manipur. This comes in the backdrop of vociferous demands for the contentious law to be lifted after 13 civilians were killed in Nagaland's Mon district in December 2021 during a botched security operation—and recommendations from a committee formed thereafter. In support of its move, the Centre cited data showing a 74 per cent drop in militancy incidents in these regions in 2014-2021. AFSPA continues in some Northeast districts as also Jammu & Kashmir, where an army captain was court-martialled on April 3 for his involvement in a fake encounter, killing three innocent civilians.

By **KAUSHIK DEKA**

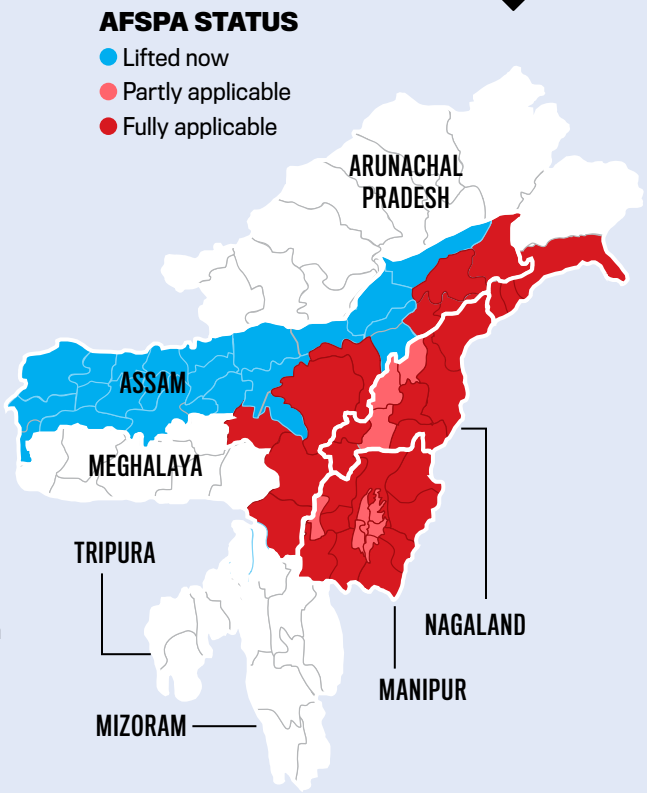


From which areas has AFSPA been lifted?

IN ASSAM, from 23 districts entirely—Baksa, Barpeta, Biswanath, Bongaigaon, Chirang, Darrang, Dhemaji, Dhubri, Goalpara, Hailakandi, Hojai, Kamrup, Kamrup Metropolitan, Karimganj, Kokrajhar, Lakhimpur, Majuli, Morigaon, Nagaon, Nalbari, Sonitpur, South Salamara and Udalguri—and all areas of Cachar district except Lakhipur subdivision

IN NAGALAND, from 15 police station areas in seven districts—Shamator, Tseminyu and Tuensang entirely, and Kohima, Mokokchung, Wokha and Longleng partially. Ironically, AFSPA remains in force in Mon district.

IN MANIPUR, from 15 police stations in the districts of Jiribam, Thoubal, Bishnupur, Kakching, Imphal East and Imphal West



When was AFSPA introduced in the NE?

Nagaland
1958

Mizoram
1967, removed in 1986

Tripura
1970, removed in 2015

Manipur
1980

Arunachal Pradesh
1987

Assam
1990

Meghalaya
1990, removed in 2018

Graphic by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY